

The Establishment of Pakistan: Early Problems.

Q. What immediate problems were faced by Pakistan in the establishment of Pakistan. Mention at least 10 problems.

When Pakistan had gained Independence in August 1947, it had little to no resources for the establishment of a newly found country. From governmental infrastructure problems to political instability, Pakistan struggled. The following are problems faced by Pakistan in its Early Establishment:

① Geographical Problems:

-) Pakistan came into existence in the form of two separate wings: East and West Pakistan.
-) The two wings were separated by 1000s of miles, which made it difficult to govern as a country.
-) It caused major communication and administration problems amongst the two wings.
-) The two wings even had people of different ideals, making it hard to please both the sides.

② Kashmir Issue:

-) The State of Jammu and Kashmir has been the biggest problem of Indo-Pakistan and the bore of contention since 1947.
-) The Ruler of Jammu and Kashmir, the Maharaja was Hindu

but the area was of Muslim majority.

-) The Raja wanted independence from both countries, he tried to drive out Kashmiris forcefully.
-) Kashmiris retaliated to overthrow the Ruler, who then asked India for help in place of Accession to India.
-) Before this only the Indians had tried to lead the Dogra forces at Poonch in a brutal massacre, Pakistan tried to stop them.
-) Eventually, a cease fire from UN resulted in Kashmir being a disputed territory which Indians claimed was their own as the Maharaja was on their side.

(3) Canal Water Dispute :

-) It was a direct result of the unfair Radcliffe Award, by which Gurdaspur, Ferozepur and Jirawar were given to India.
-) This gave India access to the head works of the Indus tributaries in Ferozepur, which they then claimed had complete rights over.
-) In 1948, India cut off water to Pakistan in breach of Arbitral Tribunal's recommendation.
-) Pakistani government claimed that under International law, it had right to the access of water.
-) In 1960, Nehru came and signed a world Bank treaty for continuing flow of water known as "Indus Basin Treaty".

(4) Division of Assets

-) The Division of Assets were to be done in a 17:5 ratio for India and Pakistan respectively, but India was very non-compliant.
-) Pakistan had been awarded Rs. 750 million out of which it was only given Rs. 200 million. It was further stopped by Nehru on the basis that it would be used in war effort in Kashmir against India.

Pakistan was not also given its military share of assets. This was a blow to Pakistan's security since it not even had factories producing military goods and whatever goods did arrive from India with either damaged or obsolete equipment.

- o) Gandhi forced India to transfer Pakistan's money but he was killed by a Hindu extremist.
- o) India did everything possible to ensure Pakistan ^{would} ~~did not~~ survive.

⑤ Refugees and Refugees

- o) After the partition, there were widespread riots throughout Northern and Central India.
- o) Then the biggest migration in human history took place as millions of Muslims and millions of Hindus and Sikhs crossed borders in opposite directions to India and Pakistan.
- o) Communal violence reached its peak as Murder, rape and arson took place on both sides and an estimated 1 million died.
- o) Then the 20 million refugees who were left at Pakistan's doorstep had to be fed and accommodated out of a very limited supply of resources.

⑥ Princely states

- o) The leaders of Princely states were asked to choose between India and Pakistan. Hyderabad and Junagadh were where decision was more difficult to make.
- o) Hyderabad was a Hindu majority area but the Ruler was Muslim who wanted to accede to Pakistan. India made it impossible and after Jinnah's death. The Indian troops entered Hyderabad, dismantled the state and incorporated it into other provinces of India.

-) Junagadh was mostly comprised of non-Muslim population. The ruler wanted to accede to Pakistan. Indian government sent troops, imposed a blockade and soon the state was short of food.
-) India forcibly invaded the area which Pakistan termed as an illegal occupation, protesting to UNO.

(7) Political Problems:

-) India had inherited government buildings, furnishings and even officials from British India. Pakistan had to start from ground zero.
-) Pakistan did not have any reasonable accommodation available to set up government offices.
-) There was an acute shortage of competent and experienced officials in the central and Provincial governments.
-) There was a lack of a capital city and no constitution had been designed in the early stages as well.

(8) Economic Problems:

-) Pakistan's industry was very underdeveloped.
-) Pakistan was not a wealthy country and could not produce a surplus to create wealth needed for industrialization.
-) Jute was a source of major foreign exchange earnings for many years but with the partition, Pakistan faced the problem that it did not have a single jute mill.

(9) Patchoon Movement:

-) In West Pakistan, Patchoons wanted to have a separate nation and were backed by Afghan Rulers.
-) It was a threat to undo the unity, solidarity and security of the state of Pakistan.

Linguistic Problems:

Pakistan was separated into East and West wings which caused linguistic problems.

1) Bengalis of East wing wanted Bengali to be adopted as the national language while Urdu was considered to be the national language in the west wing.

2) This led to a lot of controversies between the 2 wings.

(11) Health Problems:

1) The 20 million refugees that arrived in Pakistan led to the growth of epidemic and sanitation problems.

2) Unhygienic conditions prevailed as the area inherited by Pakistan did not have adequate medical supplies, doctors and nurses.

(12) Educational Problems:

1) At the time of partition, Pakistan ranked among the countries with the lowest literacy rates.

2) 90% of Pakistan was illiterate.

3) In East wing, 80% of the educational institutes were run by Hindus, who had left posts vacant while migrating to India.

4) Out of the ~~total~~ 21 universities, Pakistan only inherited 2.

5) The number of schools were also inadequate.

